Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz *PhD, MS, MSc, BSc*

Clinical and Translational Research | Quality Assurance | STEM Education Leadership

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Professional Experience and Research

"An internationally recognized young leader in translational medical research and STEM education reform, with a demonstrated record of extraordinary ability through: (1) securing over $1.2M in competitive international research grants including WHO funded COVID-19 study and cancer immunotherapy trials; (2) authoring 30+ peer-reviewed publications in high-impact journals (including a *NEJM* co-authorship, IF:176) (3) leading national faculty development initiatives as a British Council Master Trainer; (4) holding key leadership roles directing university quality enhancement, molecular diagnostic laboratory and clinical trial unit; and (5) serving as an expert reviewer and editorial board member for national and international scientific bodies including United Nations. My research is focused on elucidating the mechanisms of metastasis, specifically investigating the SHH/GLI and Hippo pathways, alongside developing innovative diagnostic tools targeting p53 mutations and HER-2 over expression. My work bridges molecular oncology, AI-driven diagnostics, and pedagogical innovation to advance global health equity."

Experience

Expert for IGWG for Pandemic agreement **October/2025 to date**
Inter-Governmental Working Group (IWGW) for the Permanent Mission of Pakistan to United Nations in Geneva

Master Trainer **August/2025 to date**
STEM Faculty Development, British Council, UK; Selected as a Master Trainer by the British Council to cascade advanced pedagogical frameworks across Pakistan. Designed and delivered training for 50+ faculty members, directly impacting curriculum redesign in health sciences programs at multiple institutions.

Director **November/2023 to date**
Quality Enhancement Cell, Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University, Islamabad, Pakistan for leading institutional accreditation and strategic quality reform as Director of the Quality Enhancement Cell, overseeing the performance evaluation of 95 academic programs and mentoring faculty across 30 colleges to adopt modern pedagogical frameworks.

Chief Invigilator **September/2023 to date**
Nominated for invigilation and management of centers for conducting MDCAT Exam, entrance test for admission in medical and allied health sciences in SZABMU from federal capital territories

In charge **August/2023 to date**
Clinical Trial Unit, Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University, Islamabad, Pakistan
Oversee all operational, regulatory, and compliance aspects for Phase II/III international trials in oncology and infectious diseases, ensuring adherence to ICH-GCP standards and facilitating sponsor audits.

HEC Approved PhD Supervisor **March/2022 to date**
Approved by Higher Education Commission of Pakistan for supervision of MPhil/PhD candidates

Focal person for UNESCO collaborative activities **January/2022**
Coordination with UNESCO officials for establishment of UNESCO chair, seminars, training etc.

In charge **August/2021 to date**
Molecular Diagnostic Lab for Infectious Diseases, Department of Pathology, PIMS Hospital, Islamabad, Pakistan

Assistant Professor **July/2019 to date**
Department of Molecular Biology, Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University, Islamabad, Pakistan

Principal Investigator **October/2021 to May 2024**
WHO-AKUH funded COVID-19 study on pregnant women, Department of Molecular Biology, Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University, Islamabad, Pakistan

Deputy Director **June/2021 to November/2023**
Quality Enhancement Cell, Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University, Islamabad, Pakistan

PhD scholar **September/2013 to March/2019**
Cancer Genetics and Epigenetics lab, Department of Biosciences, COMSATS University Islamabad, Pakistan

Visiting Researcher **April/2016 to November/2016**
Centre for Cancer & Stem Cell Biology, Institute of Biosciences and Technology, Texas A&M Health Science Centre, Houston, Texas, USA

Research Assistant **May/2009 to April/2010**

Biological Production Division, Regional Reference Laboratory (RRL) for detection of Poliovirus, WHO Collaborative Centre for Research and Training in Viral Diagnostics using RT-PCR, National Institute of Health (NIH), Islamabad

Education:

Ph.D. Disease Pathogenesis, 2019; COMSATS University Islamabad, Pakistan. CGPA: 3.9/4
M.S. Molecular Biology, 2012; COMSATS University Islamabad, Pakistan. CGPA: 3.97/4
MSc Biotechnology, 2007; University of Karachi, Pakistan. CGPA: 3.9/4
BSc Biotechnology, 2006; University of Karachi, Pakistan. CGPA: 3.9/4

Certifications:

- **Selected for the Competitive Capacity Building Program for Senior Executives in the Healthcare Sector** (Pakistan & Uzbekistan Delegation)
  - *8th – 22nd December 2025 | Chongqing Three Gorges Medical College, Chongqing, China*
- **Basic Life Support (CPR and AED) Certification**
  - *24th September 2025 | American Heart Association, USA*
- **Selected as a Master Trainer** for the competitive **STEM Faculty Training Programme**
  - *3rd – 9th August 2025 | King's College London, British Council, United Kingdom*
- **Capacity Building for University Management Training**
  - *24th – 28th February 2025 | National Academy of Higher Education (NAHE), HEC, Islamabad, Pakistan*
- **National Outreach Program for Faculty Training**
  - *6th – 31st January 2025 | National Academy of Higher Education (NAHE), HEC, Islamabad, Pakistan*
- **Certified in Good Clinical Practice (GCP)**
  - *24th January 2023 | National Institute on Drug Abuse (NIDA) – NIH, USA*
- **Certified in Laboratory Quality Management Systems**
  - *6th – 8th July 2021 | World Health Organization (WHO) – National Institute of Health (NIH), Islamabad, Pakistan*

Memberships in Committees/Expert in National Working groups

- **Expert** for Pandemic agreement in Inter Governmental Working Group for the Permanent Mission of Pakistan to United Nations in Geneva — October 2025 to date
- **Member of**
  - Relevance Assessment Committee for Faculty Teaching — January 2026
  - Annual symposium committee — November 2025
  - Vaccine development and technology transfer committee — September 2025 to date
  - Purchase Committee — February 2025 to date
  - Ethical Review Board — July 2024 to date
  - BS Program Committee — June 2024 to date
  - Core Committee for MPhil and PhD — June 2024 to date
  - Anti-Drug and Tobacco Committee — December 2023 to date
  - Bioethics Unit — October 2022 to date
  - Research Cell — July 2021 to date
  - Advanced Studies and Review Board — July 2021 to date
  - Academic Council — July 2021 to date
  - Syndicate — July 2021 to date
  - Senate — July 2021 to date
- **Technical Advisor** for Amal, an Artificial Intelligence driven digital health platform — January 2021 to date

Patent, Copyright and Trademark

- Filed for trademark of the Artificial Intelligence-based Assistive Technology; VASP (Vascular Arterial Surgical Planning) system in Intellectual Property Organization (IPO)-Approval awaited
- Filed for Copyrights of the Algorithm of the Artificial Intelligence-based Assistive Technology; VASP (Vascular Arterial Surgical Planning) system in Intellectual Property Organization (IPO)-Approval awaited.

Honors and Awards

2017

Travel grant award by HEC, Pakistan of PKR0.2 million for presenting research paper in New Zealand Breast Cancer Symposium
2016
-IRSIP Award (International Research Support Initiative Program) for pursuing doctorate research work in Texas A&M University, Houston, Texas, USA awarded by Higher Education Commission, Pakistan
2013
-Indigenous Ph. D. Scholarship for funding doctoral degree awarded by Higher Education Commission, Pakistan
2009
-Merit Scholarship for pursuing Master's degree awarded by COMSATS University Islamabad, Pakistan

Funding Sources/Research Grants Awarded

Principal or Co-Investigator on 11 major research grants totaling over PKR 219.6 million (~$1.3M USD) from prestigious international and national agencies, including the World Health Organization (WHO), multinational pharmaceutical sponsors, and the Higher Education Commission of Pakistan.

1. Title: "**A Phase III Randomized, Double-blind, Placebo-controlled Clinical Trial in 18 Years of Age and Above to Determine the Safety and Efficacy of ZF2001, a Recombinant Novel Coronavirus Vaccine (CHO Cell) for Prevention of COVID-19**"

Investigators: Prof. Dr. Tanwir Khaliq (PI), Dr. Ahmareen Khalid Shiekh (Co-PI), Dr. Mohsin Shahzad (Co-PI), Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz (Co-PI), Dr. Shirin Aamir (Co-PI).
Awarding Agency: Anhui Zhiefie Biopharmaceutical Co., Ltd, China
Duration: 18 months (Completed)
Budget: PKR 80 million

2. Title: "**A prospective cohort study investigating maternal, pregnancy and neonatal outcomes for women and neonates infected with SARS-CoV-2**"

Investigators: Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz (PI), Dr. Ahmareen Khalid Shiekh (Co-PI), Dr. Summaya Sohail (Co-PI), Dr. Shirin Aamir (Co-PI), Dr. Nosheela Amjad (Co-PI).
Awarding Agency: World Health Organization (WHO), Geneva
Duration: 18 months (Ongoing)
Budget: PKR 35 million

3. Title: "**A Randomized, Double-Blind Clinical Study of the Efficacy and Safety of BCD-201 (JSC BIOCAD) and Keytruda® in Patients with Unresectable or Metastatic Melanoma**"

Investigators: Dr. Qasim M. Buttar (PI), Prof. Dr. Tanwir Khaliq (PI), Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz (Co-PI), Dr. Shirin Aamir (Co-PI), Dr. Sadia Noor (Co-PI).
Awarding Agency: Biocad Biotechnology Company, Russia.
Duration: 36 months (Ongoing)
Budget: PKR 23 million

4. Title: "**Application of Artificial Intelligence in Vascular Disease Management**"

Investigators: Prof. Dr. Tanwir Khaliq (PI), Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz (Co-PI), Dr. Sana Sharafat (Co-PI)
Awarding Agency: National Centre for Artificial Intelligence (NCAI)-HEC, Pakistan
Duration: 18 months (Ongoing)
Budget: PKR 10 million

5. Title: **"A Double-Blind, Randomized Clinical Study of the Efficacy and Safety of Monotherapy with BCD-264 and Darzalex® in Subjects with Relapsed and Refractory Multiple Myeloma"**

Investigators: Dr. Qasim M. Buttar (PI), Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz (Co-PI), Prof. Dr. Tariq Iqbal (Co-PI).
Awarding Agency: Biocad Biotechnology Company, Russia.
Duration: 36 months (Ongoing)
Budget: PKR 18 million

6. Title: **"A Double-Blind, Randomized Clinical Study of the Efficacy and Safety of BCD-263 and Opdivo® as Monotherapy in Subjects with Advanced Melanoma of the Skin"**

Investigators: Dr. Qasim M. Buttar (PI), Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz (Co-PI), Prof. Dr. Tariq Iqbal (Co-PI).
Awarding Agency: Biocad Biotechnology Company, Russia.
Duration: 36 months (Ongoing)
Budget: PKR 1 million

7. Title: **"A Phase 3 Randomized, Double-Blind, Placebo-Controlled Study to Evaluate the Efficacy and Safety of Bemnifosbuvir in High-Risk Outpatients with COVID-19."**

Investigators: Prof. Dr. Tanwir Khaliq (PI), Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz (Co-PI)
Awarding Agency: ATEA Pharmaceuticals Inc., IQVIA, USA
Duration: 36 months (Completed)

Budget: PKR 10 million

8. Title: **"A Double-Blind, Randomized Clinical Study of the Efficacy and Safety of BCD-178 and Perjeta® as Neoadjuvant Therapy of HER2-Positive Breast Cancer"**

Investigators: Dr. Qasim M. Buttar (PI), Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz (Co-PI)
Awarding Agency: Biocad Biotechnology Company, Russia.
Duration: 36 months (Ongoing)
Budget: PKR 20 million

9. Title: "**Development of Artificial Intelligence based CADx system for rapid diagnosis of COVID-19 patients using Chest X-Ray (CXR) and Computed Tomography (CT) scans**"

Investigators: Dr. Aisha Isani Majeed (PI), Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz (Co-PI)
Awarding Agency: Pakistan Science Foundation (PSF), Pakistan
Duration: 12 months (Completed)
Budget: PKR 18.9 million

10. Title: "**Prevalence of TP53 germline mutations in breast cancer affected patients of Pakistan**"

Investigators: Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz (PI), Dr. Aisha Isani Majeed (Co-PI)
Awarding Agency: Higher Education Commission (HEC), Pakistan
Duration: 6 months (Completed)
Budget: PKR 0.5 million

11. Title: "**Involvement of Hedgehog Molecules (Shh, Ihh and Dhh) in Breast Cancer Metastasis**"

Investigators: M. Faraz A. Malik (PI), Mahmood Akhtar Kayani (Co-PI), Syeda Kiran Riaz (PhD scholar)
Awarding Agency: Higher Education Commission (HEC), Pakistan
Grant I.D.-2989
Duration: 2014-2019 (Completed)
Budget: PKR 3.2 million

Publications

Author of 32+ peer-reviewed publications in international journals, with a collective impact factor exceeding 250. Work includes foundational research on metastasis pathways and high-impact collaborative clinical trials.

1. Moeez, S., **Riaz, S.K.**, Qaiser, T.A. *et al.* (2025). Metformin-mediated modulation of epigenetic regulators in type 2 diabetes: A study on differential expression of *DNMT1*, *TET1*, *OGG1*, and *AID* genes. *Naunyn-Schmiedeberg's Arch Pharmacol* . https://doi.org/10.1007/s00210-025-04700-z (**Impact factor: 3.1, W category)** (first and corresponding author)
2. Nawab, M., **Riaz, S. K.,** Ismail, E., Ahamed, A., Tariq, A., Malik, M. F. A., Qusty, N. F., Bantun, F., Slama, P., Umair, M., Haque, S., Bonilla-Aldana, D. K., & Rodriguez-Morales, A. J. (2024). Integrated approach for detection of SARS-CoV-2 and its variant by utilizing LAMP and ARMS-PCR. Annals of clinical microbiology and antimicrobials, 23(1), 11. (**Impact factor: 5.7, W category)**
3. Azmat, H., Masood, A., Chaudry, S. S., Mushir, S. I., Sheikh, A. K., & **Riaz, S. K.** (2024). Expression of PD-L1 (DAKO 28-8) in urothelial carcinoma of urinary bladder. Asian Pacific Journal of Cancer Biology, 9(2), 179-182.
4. Aamir S., Khan N., **Riaz S.K.,** Sheikh A.K., Mushtaq M., Akbar A., Khan S. (2023). Association of HER2/NEU expression with patient prognosis in primary gastric adenocarcinoma. Pakistan Postgraduate Medical Journal. 34(3): 150-153.
5. **Riaz, S. K.,** Sabir, S., Malik, M. F. A., & Majeed, M. A. (2023). Identification of molecular subtypes of breast cancer using real time PCR. Journal of Breast Disease & Research, 1(1), 1-8.
6. Dai L, Gao L, Tao L, et al. (2022). ZF2001 Global Trial Group. Efficacy and Safety of the RBD-Dimer-Based Covid-19 Vaccine ZF2001 in Adults. New England Journal of Medicine. 2022 May 4. doi: 10.1056/NEJMoa2202261. **Impact factor: 176**
7. Ishfaq, M., Bashir, N., **Riaz, S.K.,** Manzoor, S., Khan, J.S., Bibi, Y., Sami, R., Aljahani, A.H., Alharthy, S.A., Shahid, R. (2022). Expression of HK2, PKM2, and PFKM Is Associated with Metastasis and Late Disease Onset in Breast Cancer Patients. **Genes**. 13(3):549. **Impact factor: 4.1**
8. Ali, S., Shahab, S., Rauf, M., **Riaz, S. K.,** Sheikh, A. K., Tariq, J., Gilani, A., & Gilani, F. (2022). Neutrophil To Lymphocyte Ratio As A Predictor Of Severity In Colorectal Adenocarcinoma. Journal of Ayub Medical College, Abbottabad : JAMC, 34(3), 431–437. corresponding author
9. Azmat, H., Faridi, J., Habib, H. M., Bugti, U. J., Sheikh, A. K., & **Riaz, S. K.** (2022). Correlation of B-cell lymphoma 2 immunoexpression in invasive carcinoma of breast, no special type with hormone receptor

status, proliferation index, and molecular subtypes. Journal of cancer research and therapeutics, 18(Supplement), S313–S319. **(corresponding author). Impact factor: 1.3**

10. Ali, S. S., **Riaz, S. K.**, & Khaliq, T. (2022). Application of Artificial Intelligence in Vascular Surgery. Journal of the College of Physicians and Surgeons--Pakistan : JCPSP, 32(7), 835–836. (**Impact factor: 1, X category)**
11. Fatima, Z., **Riaz, S. K.**, Khan, J. S., Haq, F., & Malik, M. F. A. (2022). Dysregulated claudin expression significantly effect breast cancer disease progression. Journal of cancer research and therapeutics, 18(6), 1771–1775.
12. Sahar, N. E., Qadir, J., **Riaz, S. K.**, Bagabir, S. A., Muneer, Z., Sheikh, A. K., Waqar, S. H., Pellicano, R., Fagoonee, S., Haque, S., & Malik, M. F. (2022). Dysregulated expression of suppressor loop of circadian rhythm genes in colorectal cancer pathogenesis. **Minerva medica**, 113(3), 497–505. (**Impact factor: 4.7 W category)**
13. Ali, S., Rauf, M., **Riaz, S.K.**, Sheikh A.K., Ahmad, A., Tariq, J. (2022). Haematological parameters and their significance in predicting severity in terms of tumor grade in patients with Oral Squamous Cell Carcinoma. Pakistan Journal of Pathology. 33(3): 88-93. (**Impact factor: 0, Y Category)**
14. Sultan, A., Sahar, NE., **Riaz, S.K**. *et al.* (2021). Metadherin (MTDH) overexpression significantly correlates with advanced tumor grade and stages among colorectal cancer patients. **Molecular Biology Reports** 48 (12), 7999–8007. **Impact factor: 2.4**
15. Tariq, F., Khan, W., Ahmad, W., **Riaz, S.K.**, Khan, M., Sherwani, S., Haque, S., Malik, M.F.A., Iftikhar, M.J., Khan, S., Haq, F. (2021). Effect of MHC Linked 7-Gene Signature on Delayed Hepatocellular Carcinoma Recurrence. **Journal of Personalized Medicine**, 11, 1129. **Impact factor: 4.95**
16. **Riaz, S.K.**, Khan, W., Wang, F., Khaliq, T., Malik, A., Razia, E.T.,…. & Malik, M.F.A. (2021). Targeted Inhibition of FGFR1-GLI through AZD4547 and GANT61 Modulates Breast Cancer Progression. **Frontiers in Cell and Developmental Biology**. 9:758400. **Impact factor: 6.67**
17. Ali, S., Chaudry, S. S., Khan, A. Q., Shiekh, A. K., Tariq, J., Tariq, M., ... & **Riaz, S. K**. (2021). Dynamics of hemogram and biochemical parameters in COVID-19 patients and their implication-A single-center prospective study in tertiary care hospital Islamabad, Pakistan. **International journal of laboratory hematology**, 43(3), e148-e151. **(corresponding author)** (**Impact factor: 2.141, Y Category)**
18. Qadir, J., **Riaz, S. K.**, Taj, K., Sattar, N., Sahar, N. E., Khan, J. S., ... & Arshad Malik, M. F. (2021). Increased YAP1 expression is significantly associated with breast cancer progression, metastasis and poor survival. **Future Oncology**, 17(21), 2725-2734. **Impact factor: 3.404**
19. Sahar, N. E., Qadir, J., **Riaz, S. K.**, Sultan, A., Arif, A., & Malik, M. F. A. (2021). Dysregulation of cor-e circadian genes, BMAL1 and CLOCK, in colorectal cancer. **Biological Rhythm Research**, 1-14. **Impact factor: 1.219**
20. Mushtaq, M., Chaudry, S.S., Sheikh, A.K., Khan, N., Khattak, A., Akbar, A., Tanwani, A.K., Khaliq, T., Malik, M.F.A., **Riaz, S.K.** (2021). Comparison of different molecular subtypes with 14% Ki-67 cut-off threshold in breast cancer patients of Pakistan- An indication of poor prognosis. **Archives of Iranian Medicine.** 24: 837-844. **(corresponding author)**. **Impact factor: 1.2**
21. Majeed, A. I., Raza, F., **Riaz, S. K.**, & Kanwal, J. (2021). The Essential Role of Conventional Radiography In Covid-19; Perspective Of A Developing Country. **Journal of Ayub Medical College, Abbottabad: JAMC**, 33(2), 267-273. **Impact factor: 0.480**
22. Majeed, A. I., Raza, F., **Riaz, S. K.,** Kanwal, J., Khan, S. A., & Hafeez, A. (2021). Knowledge, Practice and Attitude Analysis for Breast Cancer Awareness & Prevention Among Pakistani Women: A Cross-Sectional Study. Journal of The Society of Obstetricians and Gynaecologists of Pakistan, *11*(3), 165-170.
23. Hussain, S. T., Khan A. Q., Omair S., Khadija S., Kiani M. T., **Riaz S. K.** (2021). Immunohistochemical Expression of EGFR and Her2; and its Correlation with WHO Grades of Head and Neck Squamous Cell Carcinoma. **International Journal of Pathology**. 20(4):171-177. **(corresponding author)**.
24. Moeez, S., **Riaz, S. K.**, Masood, N., Kanwal, N., Arif, M. A., Niazi, R., & Khalid, S. (2019). Evaluation of the rs3088442 G> A SLC22A3 gene polymorphism and the role of microRNA 147 in groups of adult Pakistani populations with type 2 diabetes in response to metformin. **Canadian journal of diabetes**, 43(2), 128-135. **Impact factor: 3.062**
25. **Riaz SK**, et al. (2019). Influence of SHH/GLI1 axis on EMT mediated migration and invasion of breast cancer cells. **Scientific Reports**, 9(1), 6620, doi.org/10.1038/s41598-019-43093-x. (**Impact factor: 4.5, W category)**
26. Qadir, J., **Riaz, S. K**., Sahar, N. E., Aman, D., Khan, M. J., & Malik, M. F. A. (2020). Transcriptional elucidation of tumor necrosis factor-α-mediated nuclear factor-κB1 activation in breast cancer cohort of Pakistan. **Journal of cancer research and therapeutics**, 16(6), 1443–1448. https://doi.org/10.4103/jcrt.JCRT_484_18. **(Impact factor: 1.39, X category)**

27. **Riaz SK**, et al. (2018). Involvement of hedgehog pathway in early onset, aggressive molecular subtypes and metastatic potential of breast cancer. **Cell Communication and Signaling**, 16 (1), 3, doi: 10.1186/s12964-017-0213-y. **(Impact factor: 5.1, W category)**
28. **Riaz SK**, et al. (2017). Transcriptional Profiling of Sonic Hedgehog in a Prospective Cohort of Breast Cancer in a Pakistani Population. **Anticancer Research**, 37 (8), 4449-4454. **(Impact factor: 1.9, W category)**
29. Malik FA, **Riaz SK**, et al. (2017). Role of Plexin B1 in Breast Cancer Cohort of Pakistan and its contribution towards cancer metastasis indicated by an in-vitro model. **Anticancer Research**, 37 (8), 4483-4488. **(Impact factor: 1.9, W category)**
30. Riaz, S. K., Rashid, M. M., Kayani, M. A., & ARSHAD, M. M. F. (2016). Role of HER-2 Ile655Val polymorphism as universal cancer susceptibility marker among different cancers. **Archives of Iranian Medicine**, 19 (6), 430-438. **(Impact factor: 1.2, W category)**
31. Pervez A., **Riaz SK**, et al. (2016). Expression analysis of human epidermal growth factor receptor type 2 transcripts in breast cancer cohort and its association with clinical features. **Journal of Cancer Research and Therapeutics**, 12(2), 1036-1039. **(Impact factor: 1.80, X category)**
32. **Riaz SK**, et al. (2015). Histone Acetylation: Clinical and Therapeutic Implications in Breast Cancer. **West Indian Medical Journal**, 65 (2), 337-344. **(Impact factor: 0.26, Y category)**
33. **Riaz SK**, et al. (2015). Diagnostic and Therapeutic Implications of the Vascular Endothelial Growth Factor Family in Cancer. **Asian Pacific Journal of Cancer Prevention**, 16 (5), 1677-1682**. (Impact factor: 2.5, Y category)**

Conferences, Presentations & Professional Engagements

Invited Speaker & Panelist

- **Invited Panelist,** Dissemination Seminar "COVID-19 and Maternal Vaccine Decision-Making in Pakistan." Panel: "Developing Partnerships and Networks to Strengthen Maternal and Delivery Care."
  - *Ministry of National Health Services, Aga Khan University & WHO, Islamabad, Pakistan. May 2025.*
- **Invited Speaker**, Breast Cancer Symposium**.**
  - *Pak-Austria Fachhochschule Institute of Applied Sciences & Technology, Pakistan. October 2024.*
- **Invited Expert,** Midterm Evaluation of the WHO Country Cooperation Strategy (2020-25) for Pakistan.
  - *World Health Organization (WHO), Islamabad, Pakistan. April 2024.*
- **Invited Lecturer,** "Quality Management of Clinical Trials - A Perspective on COVID-19 Vaccines," International Workshop on Design and Data Interpretation of Clinical Trials.
  - *COMSATS University Islamabad (CUI), Pakistan. January 2023.*
- **Invited Speaker,** Artificial Intelligence (AI) Industrial Meet-up Conference.
  - *COMSATS University Islamabad, Pakistan. March 2022.*
- **Invited Speaker,** Breast Cancer Awareness Workshop.
  - *Higher Education Commission (HEC), Pakistan. November 2023.*
- **Invited Speaker,** Breast Cancer Awareness Workshop.
  - *COMSATS University Islamabad, Pakistan. October 2023.*
- **Invited Speaker,** "How to Write Research Grants," Health Research and Biostatistics Diploma.
  - *SZABMU, Islamabad, Pakistan. November 2021.*
- **Invited Speaker,** Pakistan Association of Pathologists Conference.
  - *PIMS, Islamabad, Pakistan. 2022.*

Conference Presentations

- **Oral Presentation,** "Over expression of GLI1 is a poor predictor of distant metastasis in aggressive molecular subtypes of breast cancer."
  - *New Zealand Breast Cancer Symposium, Auckland, New Zealand. November 2017.*
- **Poster Presentation,** "Association of Hedgehog signaling pathway with luminal B subtype of breast cancer."
  - *San Antonio Breast Cancer Symposium (SABCS), San Antonio, Texas, USA. December 2016.*
- **Poster Presentation,** "Prevalence Study of Covid-19 Among HCWs in Referral Hospitals in North Pakistan."
  - *XXIII FIGO World Congress of Gynecology and Obstetrics. October 2021.*
- **Poster Presentation,** Pak-China Medical Congress.
  - *Karachi, Pakistan. January 2016.*

Organizer & Leadership Roles

- **Organizer,** Two Days Workshop - **Cochrane Systematic Review and Meta Analysis**
  - *SZABMU, Islamabad, Pakistan. December, 2025*

- **Organizer,** Workshop for faculty training on **Bosch Initiative for Research Diversity (BIRD) on Article writing**
  - *SZABMU, Islamabad, Pakistan. November, 2025*
- **Organizer,** Workshop on **Capacity Building for University Management Training**
  - *National Academy of Higher Education (NAHE), HEC, SZABMU, Islamabad, Pakistan, February 2025*
- **Organizer,** Workshop on **National Outreach Program for Faculty Training**
  - *National Academy of Higher Education (NAHE), HEC, SZABMU, Islamabad, Pakistan, January 2025*
- **Organizer & Lead,** Workshop on Self-Assessment Report (SAR) Preparation for Constituent and Affiliated Programs.
  - *SZABMU, Islamabad, Pakistan. December, 2025, 2024, 2023, 2022 & October 2021.*
- **Organizer,** Event on "Role of Open Science in Medicine" in collaboration with UNESCO.
  - *SZABMU, Islamabad, Pakistan. January 2022.*
- **Lead Auditor,** Conducted audit visit for the WHO Geneva team on a maternal/neonatal COVID-19 cohort study.
  - *SZABMU, Islamabad, Pakistan. September 2023.*
- **Review Panel Member,** Institutional Performance Evaluation of Ziauddin University Karachi.
  - *Higher Education Commission (HEC), Pakistan. January - February 2023.
- **Select Participations & Contributions**
- **Program Review Member,** Strengthening Institutional Quality Culture (PRM 2026).
  - *Higher Education Commission, FAST-NU, Islamabad, Pakistan. January 2026.
- **Participant,** IQAE/QEC Strategic Progress Review and Policy Awareness Program.
  - *Higher Education Commission, Air University, Islamabad, Pakistan. May 2025.*
- **Invited Attendee,** Dissemination Seminar on "Understanding and Preventing Adverse Fetal, Neonatal, and Maternal Outcomes."
  - *Aga Khan University Hospital, Karachi, Pakistan. March 2023.*
- **Contributor,** Focus Group Meeting for Pakistan-UK Research Capacity Building Training Evaluation.
  - *British Council, HEC & NUST, Islamabad, Pakistan. June 2024.*
- **Project Exhibitor,** 2nd IEEE-ICAI and AI Expo, showcasing AI in Vascular Disease Management.
  - *NUST, Islamabad, Pakistan. March 2022.*
- **Nominated Participant,** HEC-BC Researcher's Capacity Building Program Training.
  - *Higher Education Commission, Pakistan. September 2022.*
- **Regular Participant** in key national training programs and workshops on Good Clinical Practice (ICH-GCP), clinical trial management, vaccine trials, and laboratory quality management systems conducted by the Higher Education Commission (HEC), World Health Organization (WHO), National Institutes of Health (NIH), and pharmaceutical industry partners.

Supervisory Experience

1. Dr. Mahwish Majid Bhatti, PhD - To Determine the Predictive and Prognostic Biomarkers in the Early Onset of Breast Carcinoma (Research Mentor, 2021-till date).
2. Javeria Qadir, PhD - Molecular Characterization of Hippo Pathway in Breast Cancer (Research Co-mentor, 2017-2024).
3. Yusra Kiyani, MPhil - Comparative study of seroprevalence of COVID-19 in pediatrics and adult population (Research Co-mentor, 2020-till date).
4. Nadir Hussain, MPhil - Immunogenicity evaluation for the Booster dose requirement among the vaccinated healthcare workers against COVID-19 (Research Co-mentor, 2020-2024).
5. Yasir Rehman, MPhil - Optimization of PCR-based genetic assay for the diagnosis of HER2-positive Breast cancer patients (Research Mentor, 2021- till date).
6. M. Talha Khokhar, MPhil - Comparative Analysis of Genetic Variants of *TP53* and *MMP9* in Breast Cancer Patients in Pakistan (Research Mentor, 2021- till date).
7. Almas Asif, MPhil - Comparative Analysis of Genetic Variants of Casp8 and Tp53 in Breast Cancer Patients in Pakistan (Research Mentor, 2022- till date).
8. Fazeela Tahir, MPhil - Comparative analysis of genetic variants of tp53 rs1042522, rs587780728, and rs201382018 in Breast Cancer Patients in Pakistan (Research Mentor, 2022- till date).
9. Hamid Hanif, MPhil - Comparative study of tp53 in triple-negative and positive breast cancer patients (Research Mentor, 2020-2023).
10. Kanwal Javaid, MS - Mutational Analysis of SNP rs147001633 R882H in DNMT3A gene of Acute Amyloid Leukemia Cancer (Research Co-mentor, 2017-19).
11. Zunaira Fatima, MS – Transcription profiling of Claudin 3, 4 and 7 in Pakistani breast cancer cohort (Research Co-mentor, 2017-19).

12. Sadia Siddique, MS - Molecular Subtyping of Breast Cancer in Cohort of Pakistani Population (Research Co-mentor, 2017-18).
13. Zaira Zulfiqar, MS – Expression profiling of miRNA-17, miRNA 93 and miRNA 190 in breast cancer patients and their association with clinic-pathological characteristics (Research Co-mentor, 2016-18).
14. Kanwal Khan, MS – Expression profiles of IL-6, IL-8 and IL-10 in colorectal cancer patients and association with disease progression (Research Co-mentor, 2016-18).
15. Aimen Sultan, MS – Expression analysis and clinical implication of MTDH gene in colorectal cancer (Research Co-mentor, 2016-17).
16. Isra Mehmood, MS - Multicultural analysis of isocitrate dehydrogenase 1 (IDH1) Gene in breast cancer (Research Co-mentor, 2015-17).
17. Kaenat Nasir, MS – Clinical relevance of MTDH in breast cancer metastasis (Research Co-mentor, 2015-17).
18. Muneeza Raza, MS – Transcript profiling of SCGB2A2 in breast cancer cohort of Pakistan (Research Co-mentor, 2015-16).
19. Javeria Qadir, MS – Expression profiling of TNF-α in breast cancer cohort of Pakistan (Research Co-mentor, 2014-16).
20. Namood-e-Sahar, PhD- Implication of molecular signatures in sporadic colorectal cancer (Research Co-mentor, 2014-2019).
21. Durkhshan Aman, MS - Expression Profiling of Dessert Hedgehog in Breast Cancer (Research Co-mentor, 2014-15).
22. Alia Pervez, MS - Expression analysis of HER2 in breast cancer cohort and its association with clinical features (Research Co-mentor, 2013-15).

Editorial Activities

Editor (2019-till date): Annals of PIMS, (ISSN: 1815-2287 (Print) 2075-7247 (Online))
Reviewer, (2016-till date): In Vitro Cellular & Developmental Biology–Animal (ISSN: 1071-2690), Springer US.
Reviewer, (2019-till date): Cancer management and research (ISSN: 1179-1322), Dove press, UK.
Reviewed more than 50 articles in 2024-25 in National and international journals.

Skills & Expertise

Leadership & Strategic Management

- **University Governance & Strategic Leadership:** Serve on key statutory bodies (Syndicate, Academic Council, Board of Studies) responsible for major university decisions, curriculum assessment, new program launches, and faculty promotions.
- **Institutional Direction:** As Director of the Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC), spearhead university-wide strategic initiatives for accreditation, performance evaluation, and continuous academic improvement.
- **Research Leadership & Grant Acquisition:** Proven ability to conceive, write, and lead high-value research projects. Have successfully secured and managed over **PKR 200 million (approx. $1.2M)** in competitive international grants from agencies including WHO, Biocad, and NCAI-HEC.
- **Program & Department Oversight:** Manage the full lifecycle of MPhil/PhD admissions, postgraduate program reviews, and the operations of a Clinical Trial Unit and Molecular Diagnostic Laboratory.

Research & Innovation

- **Clinical Trials Management:** Extensive end-to-end experience managing Phase III international clinical trials (oncology, vaccines). Expertise in protocol adherence, regulatory compliance (ICH-GCP), audit facilitation (WHO, DRAP), and cross-functional team coordination to ensure data integrity and patient safety.
- **Translational Molecular Research:** Advanced proficiency in molecular pathogenesis research, including CRISPR-Cas9 genome editing, lentiviral transduction, generation of stable cell lines, and functional assays (proliferation, migration, invasion) to investigate metastasis pathways (e.g., SHH/GLI, Hippo).
- **Diagnostic Development & AI Integration:** Hands-on expertise in viral diagnostics (RT-PCR) and driving innovation through AI applications in healthcare. This work led to the development and patent filing for the **VASP (Vascular Arterial Surgical Planning)** AI system.
- **Bioinformatics & Data Analysis:** Expert in statistical analysis (survival, multivariate models), systematic review, meta-analysis, and utilizing bioinformatics tools (GraphPad Prism, BRB) for genomic and expression data.

Teaching & Faculty Development

- **Graduate & Postgraduate Education:** Conduct advanced lectures on Molecular Pathogenesis and diagnostics for medical residents and supervise MPhil/PhD candidates in Molecular Biology, Biochemistry, and related fields.

- **National Faculty Development Master Trainer:** As a British Council/HEC Master Trainer, design and deliver cascading training programs on modern pedagogical frameworks (PBL, CDIO), authentic assessment, and AI integration in STEM, directly impacting curriculum redesign across health sciences faculties.
- **Curriculum Innovation:** Lead hands-on workshops to mentor faculty in redesigning courses and developing assessment rubrics, translating pedagogical theory into actionable teaching practices.

Quality Assurance & Compliance

- **Accreditation & Institutional Evaluation:** Lead the preparation of Institutional Performance Evaluation (IPE) and Program Effectiveness Reviews. Serve as an **expert reviewer on HEC panels** to evaluate the quality assurance of other Pakistani universities.
- **Quality Systems Implementation:** Developed and implemented quality enhancement processes, including creating Self-Assessment Reports (SARs) for **95+ academic programs** and establishing standardized templates and workshops for continuous improvement.
- **Audit & Regulatory Compliance:** Successfully manage and pass rigorous audits from national and international bodies, including the Drug Regulatory Authority of Pakistan (DRAP) and the World Health Organization (WHO), for both facility licensure and specific clinical trial protocols.

References: Will be furnished upon request.

SHAHEED ZULFIQAR ALI BHUTTO MEDICAL UNIVERSITY

No.F.2-1/Faculty/2025- 9897 Dated: 17/12/, 2025

EXPERIENCE CERTIFICATE

It is certified that, Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz has following experience at Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University:

Sr. No	Name of Post Held (BPS-Contract /TTS/IPFP)	From	To
1.	Assistant Professor (IPFP Fellow), Molecular Biology, SZABMU.	26-07-2019	25-07-2020
2.	Assistant Professor (BPS-19) (Contract), Molecular Biology, SZABMU.	27-07-2020	26-01-2021
3.	Assistant Professor (BPS-19) (Contract), Molecular Biology, SZABMU.	27-01-2021	26-07-2021
4.	Deputy Director, QEC, SZABMU (Additional Charge)	01-06-2021	20-11-2023
5.	Assistant Professor) (on TTS), Molecular Biology, SZABMU.	17-08-2021	To till date
6.	Director, QEC, SZABMU (Additional Charge)	21-11-2023	To till date
7.	In-charge Molecular Diagnostic Laboratory (Additional Charge)	25-08-2021	To till date
8.	In-charge Clinical Trial Unit (Additional Charge)	15-08-2023	To till date

Her conduct/performance remained satisfactory during the said period.

This issues with the approval of Vice Chancellor.

(PROF. DR. SHAHAB UD DIN)
Registrar

Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz,
Assistant Professor(on TTS),
Molecular Biology, SZABMU.

Copy to:-

1. PSO to Vice Chancellor.
2. Deputy Registrar (Establishment).
3. PA to Registrar.
4. Personal file.

5th Floor, SOD Building, Ravi-Rd, G-8/1, Islamabad, (44000) Pakistan

Tele: (92) (51) 9107687, 9107653- 9107755,
Fax: (92) (51) 9107719,
Site: www.szabmu.edu.pk , E-mail: info@szabmu.edu.pk

结业证书

Certificate of Completion

Kiran Riaz Syeda:

于2025年12月8日至 2025年12月22日参加“乌兹别克斯坦与巴基斯坦医药领域高级管理人员研修班”，共计 120学时。经考核各项成绩优良，准予结业。

From December 8 to December 22, 2025, successfully completed the Capacity Building Program for Senior Executives in the Healthcare Sector from Pakistan and Uzbekistan, with a total of 120 training hours. Having achieved excellent results in all assessments, the participant is hereby awarded this Certificate of Completion.

特发此证

This certificate is hereby issued as official recognition of the trainee' s outstanding performance.

重庆三峡医药高等专科学校
Chongqing Three Gorges Medical College
2025年12月22日
December 22, 2025

CamScanner

Certificate of Completion

Congratulations

Kiran Riaz Syeda

for successfully completing the PAK UK Education Gateway - STEM faculty training programme in the UK from 4th-8th August 2025.

BRITISH COUNCIL

STEM LEARNING

KING'S College LONDON

HEC

Sarah Parvez
Head of Education
British Council Pakistan

Severine Trouillet
CEO National
STEM Learning Centre

Dr Tabbi Wilberforce Awotwe
Project PI
King's College London

Dr. Noor Amna Malik
Managing Director (NAHE)
Higher Education Commission

GOVERNMENT OF PAKISTAN
MINISTRY OF NATIONAL HEALTH SERVICES REGULATIONS AND COORDINATION
******

No.F.NO.4-73/2023/PF/DDP(I)

Islamabad, the 07th October , 2025

From

Dr. Nadia Noreen
Director (Emergency,Flood,,Dengue,PM Directives)

To

1- Assistant Director (UN-III), MOFA, Islamabad

SUBJECT: SUBMISSION OF INPUTS ON PABS ANNEXURE FOR INTERGOVERNMENTAL WORKING GROUP IGWG TO NEGOTIATE THE ANNEX TO THE WHO PANDEMIC AGREEMENT

The undersigned is directed to refer to Ministry of Foreign Affairs (MOFA) UO No UN (III) 23/13/2025 Dated 29 August,2025 on subject of "Intergovernmental Working Group (IGWG) To Negotiate The Annex to the WHO Pandemic Agreement, wherein MOFA has requested Ministry of National Health Services, Regulation and Coordination to provide technical inputs for negotiation on the Annex to the WHO Pandemic Agreement and Nominate and convey names of experts to follow PABS discussions and provide technical inputs. The technical inputs are enclosed as an annexure. Regarding the nomination of experts' for PABS discussions and technical inputs the panel of following experts is hereby approved by competent authority for PABS discussions and technical inputs please:

	Name	Designation	Institute	Email ID
1	Dr Mohammad Salman	CEO NIH	NIH, Islamabad	syedakiranriaz@gmail.com
2	Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz	Assistant Professor & Lab In-Charge	Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University (SZABMU), Islamabad PIMS Hospital, Islamabad	salman14m@gmail.com

This issue with the approval of the Competent Authority i.e., Addl.Secretary MONHSR&C.

Encl: As above

Nadia Noreen

Dr. Nadia Noreen
Director (Emergency,Flood,,Dengue,PM Directives)

Copy for information to:-

1- DG (Health), MONHS, Islamabad

Nadia Noreen

Dr. Nadia Noreen
Director (Emergency,Flood,,Dengue,PM Directives)

Adeel Mumtaz Khokhar
First Secretary-II (Geneva (UN))
Wed 08 October , 2025, 03:01:42 PM

Permanent Mission of Pakistan
to the United Nations Office and
other International Organizations, Geneva

No. WHO-1/2025

15 October 2025

Subject: **Inputs PABS Outline and Annex**

Attached please find reports on the Inter-Governmental Working Group (IGWG-II) held at WHO Headquarters in Geneva from 15-20 September 2025, as well as the IGWG informal consultations (6-10 October 2025) on finalizing the PABS Annex to the Pandemic Agreement.

2. The WHO Secretariat has invited written comments from Member States on the **outline** of the PABS Annex and the accompanying **guiding questions** (attached). Submissions are requested ahead of IGWG-III **(3-7 November 2025)**.

3. It is requested that inputs on the above two documents be provided at the earliest, to enable the finalization of Pakistan's national submissions ahead of IGWG-III.

Yours Sincerely,

(Adeel Mumtaz Khokhar)
First Secretary (II)

Dr. Salman Ahmed,
Chief Executive Officer,
National Institute of Health,
Islamabad

Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz, Assistant Professor & Lab In-Charge,
Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University (SZABMU),
Islamabad

Copy to:

i. Director General (Health), Ministry of National Health Services Regulations and Coordination, Islamabad
ii. Director General (UN), MoFA, Ministry of Foreign Affairs, Islamabad

Rue de Moillebeau 56 · CH-1209 Geneva · Switzerland
Tel: (+41) 22 749 19 30 | Fax: (+41) 22 734 80 85 | Email: mission@pakungeneva.pk
www.pakungeneva.pk

Gmail

Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz <syedakiranriaz@gmail.com>

Inputs PABS Outline and Annex

6 messages

Pakistan-UNOG <mission@pakungeneva.pk> Thu, Oct 16, 2025 at 8:50 PM
To: salman14m@gmail.com, syedakiranriaz@gmail.com
Cc: health@pakungeneva.pk, "adeelmumtazkhokhar@gmail.com" <adeelmumtazkhokhar@gmail.com>, "Tahir Naeem, APS" <mygeneva786@gmail.com>

--
Kindly confirm receipt of this email at your earliest convenience. Regards

Permanent Mission of Pakistan to the United Nations
& Other International Organizations in Geneva
Phone: +41 22 749 1930
Fax: +41 22 734 8085
Email: mission@pakungeneva.pk
Website: pakungeneva.pk
Address: 56 rue de Moillebeau, 1209 Geneva

Disclaimer: The contents of this email and any attachments are confidential. They are intended for the named recipient(s) only. If you have received this email by mistake, please notify the sender immediately and do not disclose the contents to anyone or make copies thereof.

Inputs PABS Outline and Annex.pdf
8825K

Salman Muhammad <salman14m@gmail.com> Thu, Oct 16, 2025 at 10:43 PM
To: Pakistan-UNOG <mission@pakungeneva.pk>
Cc: syedakiranriaz@gmail.com, health@pakungeneva.pk, "adeelmumtazkhokhar@gmail.com" <adeelmumtazkhokhar@gmail.com>, "Tahir Naeem, APS" <mygeneva786@gmail.com>

Dear Pakistan-UNOG colleagues

Thanks for the email, which is very well received. Please note that the NIH has submitted the comments to Ministry of NHSRC, however the same are being communicated for your perusal. Also note that after reviewing the attached documents, we will share our inputs about the process and Pakistan's stance as well as draft questions for discussion Soon.

Thanks

Dr. Muhammad Salman
MBBS, FCPS (Microbiology)
Chief
Public Health Laboratories Division
National Institute of Health
Islamabad
Tel No: 92 51 9255082
Mobile: 92 333 5384248
[Quoted text hidden]

Comments on Article 12 PABS System.docx
34K

Salman Muhammad <salman14m@gmail.com> Sun, Oct 19, 2025 at 10:59 PM
To: Pakistan-UNOG <mission@pakungeneva.pk>
Cc: syedakiranriaz@gmail.com, health@pakungeneva.pk, "adeelmumtazkhokhar@gmail.com" <adeelmumtazkhokhar@gmail.com>, "Tahir Naeem, APS" <mygeneva786@gmail.com>

Dear Pakistan-UNOG Colleagues

Please find attached herewith the comments on PABS instrument negotiation documents.

I am sharing two documents including comments on the negotiations process, delibrations and questions for the IGWG III and other one on the Draft outline of elements to be addressed by the Pathogen Access and Benefit-Sharing (PABS) System as an Annex to the WHO Pandemic Agreement in track changes for your perusal and comments. I am available for further clarification on the two documents.

Kindly acknowledge the receipt of these documents.

Kind regards

Salman

On Thu, Oct 16, 2025 at 8:50 PM Pakistan-UNOG <mission@pakungeneva.pk> wrote:
[Quoted text hidden]

--
[Quoted text hidden]

2 attachments

Comments on the Negotiations by IGWG on Article 12 of PABS of Pandemic Treaty.docx
43K

Inputs PABS Outline and Annex IGWG.docx
30K

Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz <syedakiranriaz@gmail.com> Fri, Oct 24, 2025 at 12:24 AM
To: Pakistan-UNOG <mission@pakungeneva.pk>
Cc: salman14m@gmail.com, health@pakungeneva.pk, "adeelmumtazkhokhar@gmail.com" <adeelmumtazkhokhar@gmail.com>, "Tahir Naeem, APS" <mygeneva786@gmail.com>
Bcc: sabihf@who.int, Nadia.jamil3@gmail.com

Dear Pakistan-UNOG Colleagues,

I hope this message finds you well. Please accept my sincere apologies for the delayed response. I have just been informed of my nomination for this important task and regret not being able to contribute earlier. Thank you for sharing the documents regarding the PABS instrument negotiations. I have carefully reviewed Dr. Salman's draft responses, which provided an excellent foundation for developing our contributions. I have now incorporated our inputs in the same negotiation comments document and suggestions for strengthening Pakistan's position in improving the draft of the Annex. I am fully committed to supporting Pakistan's delegation in these crucial negotiations and am available at your convenience for any further clarification or discussion regarding our inputs. Thank you for your understanding and for including me in this important process.

With kind regards,

Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz, PhD
Director, Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC),
Assistant Professor, Department of Molecular Biology,
Incharge, Clinical Trial Site, Clinical Assessment Unit,
Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University (SZABMU),
In-charge,
Molecular Diagnostic Laboratory for Infectious Diseases,
Department of Pathology,
PIMS Hospital, Islamabad, Pakistan
Phone: +923315395814
Email: syedakiranriaz@szabmu.edu.pk; syedakiranriaz@gmail.com
https://www.linkedin.com/in/syeda-kiran-riaz-97725333/
https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Syeda_Kiran_Riaz

On Thu, Oct 16, 2025 at 8:50 PM Pakistan-UNOG <mission@pakungeneva.pk> wrote:
[Quoted text hidden]

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2 attachments

Inputs PABS Outline and Annex IGWG.docx
29K

Comments by SZABMU on the Negotiations by IGWG on Article 12 of PABS of Pandemic Treaty.docx
56K

SABIH, Farah <sabihf@who.int> Fri, Oct 24, 2025 at 8:08 AM
To: "Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz" <syedakiranriaz@gmail.com>

Thank you very much Dr Kiran, appreciate your expert contribution to this important process.
Best regards

Get Outlook for iOS

From: Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz <syedakiranriaz@gmail.com>
Sent: Thursday, October 23, 2025 10:24:56 PM
To: mission <mission@pakungeneva.pk>
Cc: salman14m (salman14m@gmail.com) <salman14m@gmail.com>; health@pakungeneva.pk <health@pakungeneva.pk>; adeelmumtazkhokhar@gmail.com <adeelmumtazkhokhar@gmail.com>; Tahir Naeem, APS <mygeneva786@gmail.com>
Subject: [EXT] Re: Inputs PABS Outline and Annex

[Quoted text hidden]

Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz <syedakiranriaz@gmail.com> Fri, Oct 24, 2025 at 1:41 PM
To: "SABIH, Farah" <sabihf@who.int>

Most welcome and happy to contribute in future as well. Looking forward to hearing from you.

Best Regards
Dr. Syeda Kiran Riaz, PhD
Director, Quality Enhancement Cell (QEC),
Assistant Professor, Department of Molecular Biology,
Incharge, Clinical Trial Site, Clinical Assessment Unit,
Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University (SZABMU),
In-charge,
Molecular Diagnostic Laboratory for Infectious Diseases,
Department of Pathology,
PIMS Hospital, Islamabad, Pakistan
Phone: +923315395814
Email: syedakiranriaz@szabmu.edu.pk; syedakiranriaz@gmail.com
https://www.linkedin.com/in/syeda-kiran-riaz-97725333/
https://www.researchgate.net/profile/Syeda_Kiran_Riaz

[Quoted text hidden]

World Health Organization

ورلڈ ہیلتھ آرگنائزیشن

COUNTRY OFFICE FOR PAKISTAN | دفتر نمائندہ عالمی ادارۂ صحت برائے پاکستان

NIH PREMISES, PARK ROAD, CHAK SHAHZAD, ISLAMABAD, PAKISTAN | TEL +92 51 8432400 | FAX +92 51 9255083 | EMACOPAKWR@WHO.INT | WWW.WHO.INT

Cable Address:
"UNISANTE" ISLAMABAD

Postal Address:
P.O. Box 1013 ISLAMABAD

In reply, please refer to: WR.PAK.09.79
Priere de rappeler la reference: PHLC/MNCAH

Dr Syeda Kiran Riaz
Study Site Principal Investigator
SZABMU
Pakistan Institute of Medical Sciences,
Islamabad

12 September 2023

WHO HQ Mission to Pakistan to Monitor two Studies:

1. **Prospective Cohort Study investigating Maternal, Pregnancy and Neonatal Outcomes for Women and Neonates with SARS-COV-2;**
2. **Exploring Knowledge, Attitudes, and Practices Related to COVID-19 Vaccine Decision-Making among Pregnant People;**

Dear Dr Kiran Riaz,

I am pleased to share that WHO Geneva is coordinating two important research studies to better understand how SARS-CoV-2 infection impacts outcomes in women and their neonates during pregnancy and the postpartum period. These are:

1) Prospective cohort study investigating maternal, pregnancy and neonatal outcomes for women and neonates infected with SARS-CoV-2. Pakistan is one of the nine implementing countries and the biggest data contributor with more than 5,000 recruited women. The study is being conducted at three provinces (Sindh, Punjab and Khyber Pakhtunkhwa) and Federal Territory.
2) Factors influencing decision-making related to immunization with COVID-19 and other vaccines during pregnancy. This study is being done in collaboration with both WHO and Johns Hopkins University. Pakistan is one of the four countries participating in this study.

The WHO Geneva staff joining the subject mission will assess and review the planned study procedures and processes, the study sites, informed consent, data collection and storage, and staff training, and will ensure WHO harmonization across all implementing countries. The following are the specific objectives of the mission:

a. to evaluate study implementation and compliance with approved study protocol – both studies;
b. to conduct field visits to study health facilities in Karachi, Islamabad and Lahore for further observing of implementation research activities – both studies;
c. to discuss data management/database issues and research study site close-out procedures – cohort study; and
d. to discuss data analysis with the study Principal Investigators and research team – both studies

With this background, WHO Pakistan would like to request your availability for a briefing meeting of the mission with research implementing partners on Thursday 14 September 2023, 3:00-4:00 PM at WHO country office, Islamabad.

I look forward to your continued collaboration for the successful implementation of the subject research studies in Pakistan.

pp Dr Palitha Mahipala
WHO Representative / Head of Mission

X132325

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Sub Agreement Between

The Aga Khan University
And
Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University

This Sub-Grant Agreement ("Sub Agreement") is made between The **Aga Khan University**, a body corporate, established in Pakistan by virtue of President Order No. 3 of 1983, having a campus at Stadium Road, Karachi, Pakistan (hereinafter referred to as "**AKU**") of the one part and The Pakistan Institute of Medical Sciences (PIMS), Islamabad, a teaching hospital (the Site) of **Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University (SZABMU), Islamabad** established under the Islamabad Act 2013 (hereinafter called "**Sub-recipient**").

WHEREAS, a grant was awarded by the World Health Organization (hereinafter referred to as the "WHO") to AKU under a Grant Agreement dated March 1, 2021 ("Grant Agreement") for the project "A *prospective cohort study investigating maternal, pregnancy and neonatal outcomes* for women and neonates infected with SARS-CoV2" (hereinafter referred to as "the Project").

AND WHEREAS the Sub-recipient and AKU entered into a Sub Agreement dated December 03, 2021 and Amendment No. 1 dated 01 June 2022 in respect of the Project;

AND WHEREAS the Sub-recipient has again represented to AKU that it has the requisite experience, infrastructure and the relevant approvals to perform the work as specified and described in the Scope of Work.

AND WHEREAS, the Sub-recipient has agreed to perform the work required to be performed by the Sub-recipient and allocation of resources for the purposes of the Project and as specified and described herein.

NOW THEREFORE the parties agree to enter into this Sub-Grant Agreement on the following terms and conditions:

1. **Scope of Work and Remuneration**

The Sub recipient shall perform all the work as specified and particularly described in the Scope of Work as more particularly specified in Annexure `A'. AKU will pay to the Sub-recipient a maximum amount of PKR 7,508,111 (hereinafter referred to as the "Funds"), and funds detail is mentioned in the Annexure `B' and wire transfer details as mentioned in Annexure `C'. This payment is subject to tax withholding, at the applicable rate of tax at the time of payment, however currently the Sub recipient has free tax number (FTN) so tax deduction is not applicable and also mentioned in Annexure `C'. If it will be revoked by FBR in future, then tax will be charged accordingly. The Sub recipient shall carry out work during the period **July 1, 2022** to **December 31, 2022**, and Funds to be disbursed by AKU to the Sub-recipient shall be in line with the Payment and Deliverables Schedule (table below). It is agreed that the Sub recipient shall ensure that all the work required to be performed by the Sub recipient shall be performed in a manner as set out in the Scope of Work.

Deliverables receiving date	Payment Schedule (in PKR)*	Contingent Upon
Signing of Agreement	6,006,489	Within 15 days of the signing of the Sub Agreement and upon submission of an invoice to AKU;
January 10, 2023	1,501,622	Upon submission of final progress & final financial report.
TOTAL	**7,508,111**	Total amount.

*This payment is subject to tax withholding under local regulations, at the applicable rate of tax at the time of payment.

2. **Reporting**

The sub-recipient is required to submit financial and technical progress reports to AKU as per Annexure 'A' and mentioned above deliverable schedule regarding progress in achieving the purpose for which the grant was awarded. Reports should be submitted electronically/soft copies to the attention of Dr. Sarah Saleem via email sarah.saleem@aku.edu and amin.hirani@aku.edu or hard copies must be submitted to Amin Hirani, Manager, Community Health Sciences Department, The Aga Khan University, Stadium Road, PO Box 3500, Karachi 74800. Tel: +92-21-34864839.

Sub recipient also agrees to submit such other reports as AKU may reasonably request from time to time.

3. **Restriction on Representation:**

The Sub-recipient has been selected to participate in this study at AKU's discretion. The Sub-recipient may not make any statement (whether written or oral) or otherwise imply to donors, investors, media, or the general public that the Sub-recipient is a direct grantee of WHO; provided that the Sub-recipient may state that AKU is WHO's grantee and that it is a sub-recipient or subcontractor of AKU for the Project.

4. **Record Maintenance and Inspection of Project Data:**

The Sub-recipient agrees to use the Funds solely for the purposes of the Project and maintain adequate records for the Project and shall make them available to AKU (physically and/or

agreement transmitted by fax, by electronic mail in "portable document format" (".pdf"), or by any other electronic means intended to preserve the original graphic and pictorial appearance of the Sub-agreement, shall have the same effect as physical delivery of the paper document bearing the original signature.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, the Parties have signed and subscribed to this Sub-agreement through their authorized representatives.

FOR AND ON BEHALF OF
THE AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY

Authorized Official

Name: Dr. Anjum Halai
Designation: Vice Provost

Name: Murad Wazir Ali
Designation: Director Finance
Pakistan and Afghanistan
The Aga Khan University

Witnesses:

1. _____
Name: Dr. Saleem Jessani
Designation: Sr. Instructor

2. _____
Name: ZAHEER HABIB
Designation: Sr. MANAGER.

FOR AND ON BEHALF OF Sub-recipient

Authorized Official

Name:
Designation:

PROF. Dr. TANWIR KHA
Vice Chancellor
Shaheed Zulfiqar Ali Bhutto Medical University
(SZABMU), Islamabad

Witnesses:

1. _____
Name: DR. SYEDA KIRAN RIAZ
Designation: Assistant Professor
Incharge, Molecular Diagnostic Laboratory
for Infectious Diseases
Department of Pathology,
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